FT FollowThrough

The Drywall Playbook

What to say from the first call to the five-star review. Copy the lines, put them in your own words, and keep this on your phone.

1. The first call or message

Sound calm, understand the job, and book a next step. Ask:

- Is it a patch, a ceiling, a whole room or a basement?
- Was there water damage? If so, has the leak been fixed?
- Is the wall smooth or textured, and does it need to match the rest?
- Do you want it primed and painted too, or ready for your painter?

> “Thanks for calling [Business], this is [Name]. Tell me about the wall or ceiling and I’ll see how we can help.”

> “Can you send a photo with something in it for scale, like a door? I can come to measure Tuesday at 9 or Thursday at 3. Which works better?”

2. Presenting the quote

- List the area, the finish level, the number of coats, texture matching, primer and paint.
- Price ceilings and texture matching on their own lines. They take far longer than flat walls.
- Explain how you control dust: plastic walls, a vacuum sander, cleanup every day.
- Add a clause for hidden damage like wet framing or mold, priced per item.

> “Here’s the scope, here’s how we’ll keep the dust down, and here’s the price. I can start on [day]. What questions do you have?”

3. The 7 objections drywall contractors hear and what to say

Acknowledge it, ask a question, answer honestly, suggest a next step.

1. “Another contractor quoted a lot less.”
“That’s fair, I’d compare too. What finish level and how many coats are in their quote? Ask about texture, primer and cleanup too, because that’s where drywall prices differ. I’ll send photos of a finished room under bright light so you can see the difference.”

2. “I’m getting a few more quotes.”
“Good idea. What matters most to you, the finish, the dust or the timeline? Ask each contractor the same things: finish level, dust control, cleanup and how they match texture. I’ll check in Tuesday.”

3. “Can you knock something off?”
“I can adjust the scope. What number did you have in mind? A basic finish in a garage or utility room costs less than the smooth finish living rooms need. I won’t skip the coats that keep seams from showing.”

4. “I’ll just patch it myself.”
“Plenty of people do small holes. How big is it, and is it on the ceiling? Small patches are a fine DIY job. Large holes, ceilings and texture matching are where it usually shows, so I can quote just those.”

5. “Let’s wait until we’re ready to paint.”
“That can work. Was there water damage behind it? If so, waiting can let mold grow inside the wall. I can open it now to check and dry it, and finish the patch when you’re ready to paint.”

6. “Will you leave my house covered in dust?”
“Fair worry, it’s the top complaint about drywall work. Which rooms are near the work? I seal off the area with plastic, use a vacuum sander and clean up every day. Here are three recent customers you can call.”

7. “Why do you need a deposit?”
“Fair question. Have you paid a contractor up front before and regretted it? The deposit pays for the board and materials for your job. It’s in the contract, and the balance is due after we walk through the finished work together.”

4. Follow up: day 2, day 5, day 12

Most quotes go quiet, not “no”. Keep each message short and useful.

> **Day 2:** “Hi [Name], it’s [Your name] from [Business]. Did the drywall quote come through okay? Happy to answer any questions.”

> **Day 5:** “Hi [Name], here are photos of a similar room we finished recently, taken under bright light. I have an opening on [day] and can hold it until Friday.”

> **Day 12:** “Hi [Name], I’ll close out your quote on Friday. If you’d still like to go ahead, or just fix the worst spot for now, reply and I’ll hold a spot.”

Basement customers compare a few contractors. Photos of a finished room like theirs often decide it.

5. Ask for the review and the referral

Ask at the final walk-through, when the room is clean and finished, and text a direct link to your Google review page.

> “Thanks again, [Name]. If you’re happy with the room, would you leave a quick Google review with a photo? I’ll text you the link. And if a friend has a wall or ceiling to fix, I’d be glad to help.”

Painters, plumbers and remodelers all need drywall done. Leave each one your card. They can send you steady work.

Three rules that keep you out of trouble

- Test for asbestos and lead before you sand old joint compound or popcorn ceilings.
- Seal off the room and protect floors on every job. A dust claim can cost more than the job paid.
- Write down whether you fix the cause of a water stain or just the drywall, and check your state’s contractor license.

General education, not legal, tax or insurance advice. Rules and prices vary by state, so check yours.
The full start-up guide for drywall contractors: followthroughguides.com/drywall · Questions: info@followthroughguides.com